Giving a TA access to the student repositories

CS 262 course tooling · coursekit · September 2026

Your TA does not need a copy of anyone's work emailed to them. They get read access to the student repositories and clone them themselves, with the same commands you use. Nothing is sent, nothing goes stale, and a late push costs them seconds. Page 1 is yours. Pages 2 and 3 can be handed straight to the TA.

PART 1 · What the instructor does, once per TA

1. **Get the TA's GitHub username.** Their login, not their email address.
2. **Add one row to** `roster/roster.csv`. The columns are `username, first_name, last_name, email, section, github_id, role`. The GitHub login goes in `github_id`, and the role must be `grader`:

```
tmiller,Tami,Miller,,,tmiller-gh,grader
```

   A grader is never given an assignment, never graded, and never counted in the class size.

3. **Grant access.** The first line is a preview and changes nothing; the second does it.

```
cs262 access a04
cs262 access a04 --go

cs262 access --go # every assignment at once
```

   This invites the TA to the organization (one invitation, not one per repository) and grants read on all 42 student repositories plus the template. Read, never write: the run prints "0 write accesses granted". From now on, assign --go grants it automatically for any new repository.

4. **Build the folder the TA works from.**

```
cs262 access a04 --share ~/Desktop/cs262-grader
```

   A few kilobytes: course.json, the roster with email addresses blanked, and each assignment's assignment.json, starter/, answers/ and grading bundle. It also writes a README for the TA with Part 2 in it, with your real course name filled in.

5. **Send the TA two things:** that folder, zipped, and this repository, which holds the toolkit and page 2 of these notes:

```
https://github.com/ericaraujophd/26FA-Github-Grading.git
```

When you publish a later assignment, the TA gets it themselves with `cs262 fetch a05`; you only re-run `--share` over their folder if they need a grading bundle, and it leaves their settings alone.

At any point: `cs262 access a04` on its own shows who has access to what, and `cs262 access a04 --revoke --go` takes it back.

PART 2 · What the TA does

Do steps 1 to 4 once. Step 5 is what you run for every assignment.

1. **Accept the GitHub invitation first.** It arrives by email and expires after seven days. Until you accept it, the repositories are invisible to you and step 3 will fail.
2. **Install the GitHub CLI** from cli.github.com, then:

```
gh auth login # choose HTTPS when it asks
gh auth setup-git # lets git clone private repositories
```

3. **Install the toolkit and point it at the folder** your instructor sent you. It needs git, python3 and node already installed:

```
git clone https://github.com/ericaraujophd/26FA-Github-Grading.git ~/coursekit
cd ~/coursekit
./install --non-interactive --course cs262 \
--org Calvin-CS-classrooms \
--folder ~/Desktop/cs262-grader
```

   If it stops on "gh org access", step 1 is not done yet.

4. **Put the command on your PATH** if the installer says to: add the line it prints to `~/.zshrc`, open a new terminal, and check with `cs262`.
5. **Grade.**

```
cs262 collect a04 # clones all 42 into ~/cs262-grading/a04/checkouts/
cs262 sheet a04 # a CSV, sorted by last name, with empty mark columns
```

   Add --as-of "2026-10-14T23:59:59-04:00" to either one to grade what existed at the deadline. Re-running collect updates the clones instead of downloading again, so picking up a late push takes seconds.

6. **Each run tells you who moved.** Both collect and marks end with a block naming the students whose work changed since your previous run, which is the list to re-read after resubmissions:

```
Since your last collect (2026-10-28 14:02 UTC):
3 updated ada, bob, cara
1 new
9 unchanged

cs262 sheet a04 --updated # a marking sheet of only those students
```

7. **When a new assignment comes out**, you do not need a new copy of this folder:

```
cs262 fetch # what is published that you do not have
cs262 fetch a05 # pull a05's setup out of GitHub
cs262 collect a05
```

   fetch gets the starter, which is all GitHub holds. Hand-graded assignments need nothing else. An autograded one also needs the grading bundle, which only the instructor has: ask them to re-run access --share over this folder.

8. **Fill in the CSV and send it back.** Type in the `mark` and `comment` columns in a spreadsheet. Nothing reads it back automatically, so email it to the instructor.

If something looks wrong

I see no repositories at all	You have not accepted the organization invitation. The instructor can re-send it; cs262 access names who is still pending.
One student says “no repository”	That student has no GitHub username on the roster yet. Not your problem to fix; tell the instructor.
a05 is not in my folder	cs262 fetch a05 pulls its setup from GitHub. cs262 fetch on its own lists what is published and what is missing here.
Who resubmitted since I last looked?	Every collect and marks ends with a block naming them. cs262 sheet a04 --updated writes a sheet of only those students.
marks says the bundle is missing	Autograded assignments need a grading bundle, which is never on GitHub. Ask the instructor to run cs262 access a05 --share over your folder.
git asks for a password	Run gh auth setup-git again.
The command is not found	~/.local/bin is not on your PATH. See step 4.